

IT CORRIDOR

Adyar » Kanathur » Kelambakkam » Navalur » Semmencherry » Thoraipakkam » Velachery » IIT Madras » Kandanchavadi » Kottivakkam

Neelankarai » Sholinganallur » Thiruvannamiyur » Vijaya Nagar » Indira Nagar » Karapakkam » Kotturpuram » Padur » Thalambur » Pallikaralai



ALONE WITH THE TIMEPIECES

At Peer & Sons, a son is keeping his father's memory alive by enthusiastically practising a skill imparted to him by the senior **P4**



'COOKING UP' A CHALLENGE FOR CHEFS

Over 70 participants took part in this competition designed to test their culinary knowledge and kitchen skills **P3**

EFI restores waterbody in Sholinganallur

Environmentalist Foundation of India has restored Sathyavani Pond at Sathyavani Muthu Street in Sholinganallur.

Spread across 1,550 square meters, the pond was sullied by trash dumping and, at its periphery, overrun with invasive weeds. This resulted in a gradual decline in water quality, leaving a foul odour and degradation of the waterbody, said a press release.

Arun Krishnamurthy, founder of EFI, says that once the pond was a source of drinking water.

The restoration efforts included dewatering the pond, removing debris, garbage and invasive weeds, desilting the pond and building a protective boundary, the release said. A compound wall has been constructed around the pond to

prevent garbage dumping and encroachments.

The edges of the pond were carefully reshaped and strengthened using stone-lined revetments. The structures reduce soil erosion, protect the slopes (revetment walls), and improve the pond's ability to retain water during heavy rainfall. Sewage outlets that were contaminating the pond were sealed, and a dedicated inlet chamber has been constructed to ensure only rainwater enters the pond, the release added. A total of 68 native trees, including neem, jamun, pongamia and other species, were planted along the pond's periphery to enhance biodiversity. The walls along the pond have been adorned with colourful murals depicting wildlife.

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Besant Nagar school travels deep into Old Madras

Surana High Tech International School formed a celebration committee with parents to host a variety of programmes for a week

HEERA CHANDRA VENGATESH

Students and staff of Surana High Tech International School in Besant Nagar went on tour of nostalgia deep into old Madras as part of the week-long Madras Day celebrations. My mom, Swapna Sridharan, along with other parents Kavitha Vivek Aacha, Sudha Rajagopal and Tanya Kothari formed the core celebrations committee. They roped in other parents and grandparents and got them to contribute, partici-

pate and share their rich cultural experiences and knowledge on iconic buildings, transport, art and culture. Foods that included *aru suvai virundhu* with *vazhai-poo vadai*, *pachadi*, *appalam* and *payasam*, served on green banana leaves, and beachside snacks such as *sundal* and *murukku*, even *porai* biscuit and *kamarkattu* and *their mittai* were distributed.

On day one, cycle rickshaws brought to the campus transported many of us to the days when pedal-powered tricycles dominated local transport. Talks were

given by S. Rajagopal, grandfather of Aarush of Grade II and Aarav from LKG, who recounted the

history of Madras. Grandfather of Chirag of Grade IX, Kailash Bohara, spoke on the iconic buildings of the city.

On day two, Vijayashree, mother of Vairag of Grade IV, spoke on art and culture, and Dr. Venkata Subramanian, grandfather of Sanjay of Grade IV, entertained us with a number of Bharatiyar songs. The same even-

ing grandmothers of Medhams of Grade V, Indira, Bhoodevi and Vijaya, all three sisters taught us how to string flowers the traditional way as also draw the colourful kolams that decorate the entrance of many a traditional house. We were also treated to large portions of *sundal* and *murukku* by Sumathi Parthasarathy, grandmother of Suryaansh of Grade V.

A traditional feast was arranged on the third day followed by traditional games such as *dhayam*, *pallanguli*, *pandi* (hopscotch) and 'seven stones'. In the evening Kavitha exhibited and gave a demonstration lecture on traditional jewellery and attires, most of which are to be seen only in pictures now. The day ended with a treasure hunt of objects symbolic of old Madras.

We are thankful to our principal Kiran Merchant for taking us down memory lane with various events.

(Heera Chandra Vengatesh is a Grade V student of Surana High Tech International School)

Super Chennai brings a 'fresh vibe' to Medavakkam

Super Chennai launches "Community Vibes", conceived as a neighbourhood-led platform that brings together fun, fitness, culture, creativity and learning. The first edition of the initiative focussed on Medavakkam with the "centre stage" parked at a gated community in the locality, Navin's Starwood

For residents of Medavakkam, a recent Sunday morning began a little differently.

From fitness and games to music, traditional performances and creative workshops, the first edition of Super Chennai Community Vibes brought residents and families together for a morning of shared experiences at Navin's Starwood on that Sunday.

An initiative by Super Chennai, *Community Vibes* is conceived as a neighbourhood-led platform that brings together fun, fitness, culture, creativity and learning.

The first edition, held between 6 a.m. and 9 a.m. on August 9 saw enthusiastic participation from residents and families from Navin's Starwood as well as the wider Medavakkam neighbourhood., says a press release from Super Chennai.

The idea behind the initiative is to take community experiences beyond large city-wide events and into the neighbourhoods where people live.

The morning offered something for different age groups. Families and children had an opportunity to rediscover traditional and native games, many of which are becoming increasingly unfamiliar in today's urban environment, the re-

lease adds.

Children were also at the centre of several hands-on activities. Crochet, live abacus and art workshops gave them opportunities to learn, create and interact in an informal setting, while allowing parents and children to participate together.

The main stage added to the festive mood with a mix of contemporary music and traditional performances. Popular music band Maayavisai performed for the audience, while a Bharatanatyam team from the local community showcased its talent.

Traditional Thappattam and Mayilattam perfor-

At Community Vibes event in Medavakkam.

mances brought the sights and sounds of Tamil folk culture to the morning, giving both children and adults an opportunity to experience these art forms up close.

A dedicated music zone further added to the atmosphere, creating

a relaxed space for residents to gather, listen and spend time with one another.

The first edition at Navin's Starwood marked the beginning of what Super Chennai hopes will become a series of such community experiences across Chennai, says the release.

‘Cooking up’ a challenge for women chefs

Over 70 participants took part in this competition held at the Institute of Hotel Management in Taramani

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

This dish came to India from Indonesia, according to famous food historian KT Achaya. Cooks employed by Indonesian Hindu kings are believed to have made it between the 9th and 12th centuries. Name the dish.

* Designed by chemist Fred Baur using advanced computing to solve issues with broken and greasy-bagged snacks, this product's signature saddle-like shape is a mathematically optimised hyperbolic paraboloid. It comes packed in canisters to withstand transport pressure. Which engineered snack brand is this?

These two are among the



The winners along with dignitaries at the event.

questions that were posted to participants at QuizDiva, a culinary competition for women chefs, culinary professionals, and hospitality students from South India, held at Institute of Hotel Management in Taramani recently.

Over 70 participants found their knowledge and culinary

skills tested through different rounds. There were three top prizes worth ₹ 1 lakh, ₹75,000 and ₹ 50,000 to be taken away.

Designed to celebrate talent, creativity, and professional excellence, the event organised by X Quiz IT with South India Chefs Association (SICA) as collaborators

tested the participants on practical culinary challenges, knowledge of food and kitchen skills.

The quiz segments were conducted by X Quiz IT's founder and creative head Arvind Rajeev, while the overall event was handled by Arun Jayakaran Ventures (AJV).

“We have done quiz competitions for chefs in the past but this is the first time we were doing something exclusively for lady chefs who were in the fray to showcase their expertise in theory and practicals. We wanted them to look beyond the books,” says quizzer Arvind Rajeev.

With women in the hospitality industry playing an important role, QuizDiva served as a platform for recognising and encouraging them.

Niranjana Murugesan Durai, a resident of Chennai, won the first prize. After a stint in the hotel industry, she is currently running her own home-based cloud kitchen and plans to use the cash prize in her business.

Rubah Fathima and Nandhita Sriram were declared second and third prize winners respectively. A new experience for these chefs, the winners pointed out that having a quiz format in the challenge made them take “strategic guesses” and also admire the many female chefs in the industry.

Actor Thalaivasal Vijay was the special guest and he gave away the prizes.

A community unites for ‘Break The Silence’

SUNIL JAYARAM

It was an evening where the local community did not just gather—it came together to reflect, feel, and wake up.

Set against the scenic backdrop of the lake amphitheater under a cloudy evening sky, PENN and Chitlapakkam Rising organised “Break The Silence”, an event addressing women’s safety, rights, and deep-rooted societal inequality, on August 15 at the Chitlapakkam Lake Amphitheater.

Tackling a subject as sensitive as women’s safety naturally raises questions about how younger generations will interpret it. However, the school and college students who took the stage delivered performances that resonated deeply with the audience, moving spectators to laughter and reflection. Through a carefully curated mix of music, dance, and theatrical content, the youth addressed difficult truths about societal inequality.

The event drew active participation from several prominent institutions, including PENN, alongside local schools—Budding Minds, National, NSN, Rosily, Olive, and St. Marks—and colleges including MCC



Snapshots of the event; it was graced by actor Revathy.



and SIVET. Contributions from the Chitlapakkam Rising group, Crescent Crescendo, and Ananya further enriched the programme.

A “Yamalogathil BTS”, skit played by the Chitlapakkam Rising group, showcased how crimes against women are increasing and getting out of control. The skit high-

lighted some solution to empower women and sensitise our men. School and College performances portrayed the need for equality and equity.

Singappen Task Force officers from Chitlapakkam Police joined and presented the Force’s new initiatives on women’s safety.

A key highlight of the evening was the presence of noted actor and activist Revathy, who commended the students’ performances and acknowledged the tireless efforts of the local resident volunteers.

“Break the Silence’ at Chitlapakkam was a deeply moving evening, where children and teenagers came together creatively to share two powerful messages: “Raise boys better” and “Build a safer society for women and children.”

Their voices were a powerful reminder that meaningful change begins with awareness, empathy and the courage to speak up,” Revathy said. The evening culminated in a powerful collective pledge: “Vida Maattom! Vida Maattom!” (We will not give up!), signalling a unified local commitment to stand against injustice wherever it occurs.

“PENN’s vision of addressing the Gender Equality & Women, Child Safety thru behavioral change is very well exhibited in the performances of male, female participants thru various Art forms, in

‘Break The Silence’ event organised by Chitlapakkam Rising Community.”, said V S Sridhar, Founder and Managing trustee of PENN Trust.

The initiative is part of a broader, ongoing effort to improve the quality of life, safety, and dignity for women and girls in the neighborhood.

Sunil Jayaram is co-founder Chitlapakkam Rising

Two-day property expo in September



The Hindu Property Expo - 2026 will be held on September 5 and 6 at Chennai Trade Centre, Nandambakkam.

Visitors can explore a wide range of premium residences, plots, farmlands, farmhouses, commercial spaces, and investment opportunities. The expo offers an opportunity to meet developers, compare projects, and make informed property decisions.

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For details, call 9841273713 / 9841810070



Ticking on behind the barricades

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Zenith Watch Co at
Kutchery Road in
Mylapore.

Somewhere between the ticking of a century-old pendulum clock and a modern, sleek wrist watch, Zenith Watch Co. on Kutchery Road has ensured two distinct eras of time live side by side. A sweep of the eye taking in the walls of this shop that stares at Metro Rail barricades presents this sumptuous display of the past and the present. The walls are decorated with old, ornate timepieces, repaired and ready for delivery; and these walls also display shelves holding modern wristwatches out of factories and packed ready for sale.

Since 1954, this shop at Kutchery Road, near Luz signal in Mylapore, has been serving customers seeking to preserve timepieces of the past, hallowed by their personal memories, as well as watches and clocks just out of the blocks and dew-fresh in the market.

Founded by Mallick Pasha, the shop has never had a change of address. And even in these difficult times, when Metro Rail work has redrawn pathways, both for pedestrians and motorists, the shop resiliently stays put at this address. Mahaboob Pasha, who runs this family business, points out that even old customers accustomed to walking through the doors of this shop struggle to find their way to those familiar doors, as Metro Rail work has engineered a maze of new pathways through route diversions and blockages. By virtue of the diversity of its services, Zenith depends on revisits by old customers as well as walk-ins by new ones. The “barricades” across Luz Corner, on Kutchery Road and Luz Church Road hinder both processes.



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop,” he says.

But Mahaboob sounds like someone who has taken these challenges in his stride. At 58, this man has spent more than three decades amidst the “chimes of time”, having taken over the reins of the shop when he was in his twenties. Back then for this M.Com graduate, there was no dearth of career options. “This is a family business and I cannot leave it; hence I chose this,” he says. There was a time when he worked alongside the technicians at the shop, as a repairer of timepieces. Today, he sticks to

the management side of the business, leaving the repair of broken and malfunctioning timepieces to the technicians on the rolls. Mahaboob notes spare parts are sourced from Mumbai and Delhi when they are unavailable locally.

On whether a plethora of other devices marking time such as the mobile phone, the laptop and so on have made a dent in the attraction of the wristwatch, his answer is an emphatic ‘no’. Mahaboob observes that it remains firmly where it belongs: on the wrist. Largely for inveterate followers and buyers of new wristwatch models, Zenith stocks up on non-branded wristwatches, largely wallet-friendly.

On retaining his old customer base, Mahaboob notes hospitality on the other side of the counter remains an effective glue keeping that loyalty intact. While valuing face-to-face, in-person interactions, Zenith has ensured the connections are sustained by technology. Its website allows customers to track repairs using their bill numbers; it showcases wristwatches, wall clocks, and other timepieces for sale. So, what is it that sustains Zenith as it is hemmed in by Metro Rail barricades? This probably: keeping stride with technology without losing that personal, human touch.

Celebrating Madras Day (August 22), Resilience Series tracks old markets and enterprises in the city that are under the shadow of a major civic infrastructure work but are soldiering on with inimitable poise.



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop.”

Established in 1954, seller and mender of timepieces Zenith Watch Co at Kutchery Road in Mylapore has never had a change of address. In recent times, it has been facing a massive challenge on account of route diversions and road blockages caused by Metro Rail work. The enterprise however seems to have taken this difficulty in its stride. A little distance away, on the same road is a one-man enterprise Peer & Sons, established in 1963, that repairs watches and clocks; and it displays similar fortitude



Alone with the timepieces

At Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road, a son is keeping his father’s memory alive by enthusiastically practising a skill imparted to him by the senior

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

On that part of Kutchery Road, where the Buckingham Canal flows sluggishly under a bridge, S. Shakil Ahmed operates from a shop smaller than a niche in a dovecote. The shop was once larger, recalls Shakil, but as the owner reclaimed a part of it for another enterprise, it shrunk to its present dimensions. But this small shop still catches the eye for its wall displays: clocks, either *demode* or delectably antique, depending on the eye beholding them. Another eye-catching feature is the enseigne above the entrance that announces the enterprise as Peer & Sons. When quizzed about the name and its homonymic alignment with the iconic P. Orr & Sons on Mount Road, Shakil sounds a tad amused as he offers a reply: obviously, when they see this shop, they know the two are galaxies apart. But when they hear the name ‘Peer & Sons’ over the phone, they would be confused for a split second. And the name was not carefully chosen to evoke that iconic shop, remarks Shakil, just to reflect that it was started by his father S.K. Peer.

S.K. Peer had opened this shop in 1963 and continued in the saddle till his demise in 2008. Shakil relishes reminiscing about the unquestioning obedience with which he followed in his father’s footsteps, not in 2008 but way back in 1991 when the senior was at the height of his prowess as a mender of timepieces and he was just a school student. Shakil joined his father as his understudy in 1991, right after finishing his Class X board exams.

“I did not even wait for my results,” he says with a faint laugh at the memory.

“If my father asked for something, it was always a yes,” states Shakil, his decision driven by a straightforward logic: if his father needed him at the shop, that was reason enough to be there.

He observes that for parents to get a ‘yes’ from their children today, they would have to first answer a gazillion ‘whys’. Shakil, who has three children, two girls and a boy, all of them falling within the Gen Z bracket, is at peace with the current generation’s questioning mindset as they are spoilt for choice in terms of career options, and have information at hand to suss those careers out.

To a question if he ever regrets not having taken a different career path, Shakil’s answer is a ‘no’, but he qualifies it by admitting that on rare occasions,



S. Shakil Ahmed at Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road.

the thought has crossed his mind. That thought most likely occurred during the pandemic and in recent times, on account of Metro Rail work at the Luz Corner (where Kutchery Road meets Luz Church Road meet) restricting access to his shop. That thought gets counterbalanced by his awareness of the benefits of being one’s own boss.

“If there is a function, I can attend it without prior leave complications; if I want to travel, I can take a few days off and do so,” he smiles.

He has commendably built a livelihood just by the practice of the craft of repairing timepieces, has managed to give his children good and meaningful education (the two daughters are in college and the son in school).

After his father’s death in 2008, Shakil has been running the shop in a veritable one-man show spending that vast chunk of his waking hours (that is, from 10.a.m. to 9p.m.), sitting hunched over timepieces, peering at them through a magnifying eyepiece. The punch-in punch-out time is sometimes longer: during the pandemic, he began taking delicate and major repairs home, a habit that has stuck with him ever since. His workbench has witnessed everything from a Seiko to a 1960s Omega; and also those ornate tall, weight-driven pendulum clocks, colloquially called grandfather and grandmother clocks depending on their height and size. His customer base includes collectors of antique clocks. He accepts every timepiece that comes his way, from the grand to the commonplace. Repairs of antique clocks can soak up considerable time.

Availability of spare parts can sometimes pose a challenge. When unable to find spare parts, he has fashioned them himself, says Shakil. But obviously, there is a limit to what you can fashion yourself; the sustainable option is to have dealers who can hand them over to you. On a normal day though, he sources spares from dealers. He also buys old clocks to salvage those parts that are in working order.

Now, the question that stares at any enterprise sustained by successive generations. Would the next generation take the baton from Shakil and continue the legacy started by his father S.K. Peer? His children might likely choose different fields, and Shakil admits the possibility of the business continuing through them being thin. For now, Shakil remains at his bench, turning back time by getting old timepieces ticking again. And he luxuriates in the sweet sound of a timepiece ticking and sounding back to life.

Free and subsidised dialysis service providers in Chennai



LIFFY THOMAS

16 and counting

It was after a stint in Canada that nephrologist Georgi Abraham decided to start a dialysis centre at Chennai in the mid-2000s.

The Tanker Foundation Dialysis Centre started in a humble way at Georgi Abraham’s father-in-law’s house on Poonamalee High Road as it was lying vacant.

As the number of patients seeking dialysis began to shoot up, the Foundation sought a space at Rotary Ambattur Hospital where it got started on the initiative with five machines. Today, the upgraded hospital has 26 machines with 127 patients seeking dialysis under its care.

In the last two decades, this initiative to provide dialysis for patients twice or thrice a week has grown to serve people from various parts of Chennai and beyond. Dialysis is offered either free or at a subsidised rate of ₹ 375 to patients, says a note on its website.

Of the 16 centres run in Tamil Nadu by Tanker Foundation, 11 are in Chennai. “A majority of the patients are enrolled under the Chief Minister Scheme and if expenses beyond that need to be covered we find donors,” says Dr. Georgi Abraham, founder-president of the Tanker Foundation.

The patients have the choice of

opting for a centre that is closest to their home. “A patient whose kidney function is between 6 and 8 percent is eligible for dialysis, but we are particular that certain criteria are met including the financial background of the person and dialysis in an OP setting for free treatment,” says Dr. Georgi.

With rising number of kidney-related ailments, the Foundation sees a huge demand for this from of service. People who require early detection are those with high BP, history of diabetes, complaints of heart disease and a previous history of kidney disease.

For details about its various centres, visit <https://tankerfoundation.org>

***GCC-run centres

Greater Chennai Corporation runs dialysis centres in a majority of its zones. As per data put up on X, Zone IX has the maximum number of dialysis machines, 22. The unit functions from Vallorkottam Diagnostic Centre in Nungambakkam. Others are in Thiruvottiyur UCHC, Lakshmiapuram in Retteri UPHC, Elango Nagar UPHC, Padi Ambattur UCHC, Chinnai Porur in Valsarvakam UCHC; Perungudi, Injambakkam and Semmacherry UCHC;

These centres are operated with the support of NGOs and organisations. Dialysis treatment is offered free-of-cost at these centres.

Care at ₹ 600

Since Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation started in Thiruvanniyur in 2011, one thing that has stayed constant is its affordable pricing. In all these 15 years, the Foundation charges ₹ 600 per sitting from those seeking dialysis.

Started as a pet project of Lion R. Ravichandran, Past District Governor, the Foundation offers dialysis treatment for close to 250 people a month at its six-bed dialysis centre.

The cost of a single haemodialysis session ranges from ₹1800 to ₹ 3,500 in city hospitals. “Since patients need to undergo dialysis sessions two to three times a week, the monthly cost of treatment can run into several thousand rupees. We started this service to alleviate some of the hardships faced by dialysis patients and their families,” says Ravichandran.

The remaining costs are covered by the Foundation. “Although we do face shortage of funds we have somehow been able to sustain this service with the support of donors,” he says.

Nephrologist R. Vijay Kumar is the consultant guiding the Foundation.

Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation is at No 28A, South Mada Street, Thiruvanniyur, near Marundeeswarar Temple.

For details, call Ravichandran at 98410 51480/ Kalyani Ngarajan at 9841115984.

Celebration of talent, culture and togetherness

MRC Association recently hosted the latest edition of its flagship annual community festival, Shringara 2026, at the Mayor Ramanathan Chettiar Centre in MRC Nagar, drawing enthusiastic participation from residents across generations for an evening that celebrated creativity, culture and community spirit.

Shringara has evolved into one of Chennai's most vibrant residential community festivals, providing a platform for residents to discover and showcase their talents while strengthening neighbourhood

bonds, said a press release. The event featured an engaging blend of cultural performances, music, dance, fashion presentations, interactive experiences and family entertainment, reflecting the diversity and vibrancy of the MRC community. The occasion was graced by senior advocate P. R. Raman and Vikram Kapur, retired IAS officer, as guests of honour.

Speaking on behalf of MRC Association, the organising committee said: "Shringara is more than an annual festival; it is a celebration of the people who make our



Residents of MRC Nagar walk the ramp at Shringara 2026.

community special. Every year, it offers residents a stage to express themselves, discover hidden talents and create lasting memories with family and neighbours. The overwhelming response to this year's edition reinforces the spirit of togetherness that defines MRC Nagar." The Association also acknowledged the tireless efforts of its volunteers, performers, sponsors and resident participants whose commitment transformed Shringara 2026 into a memorable community celebration. As the curtains came down on another successful edition, Shringara 2026 reaffirmed MRC Association's commitment to fostering meaningful community engagement through culture, creativity and shared experiences—making it a landmark event in Chennai's residential community calendar.

It's a perfect 10

This all-women Tamil theatre troupe, a majority of them hailing from Pallikaranai and Velachery, will be staging their next production on August 29

Sarvam Nataka Priyas, an amateur all-women Tamil theatre troupe, will be presenting its 10th production, Gajasanakasi, on August 29 in Pallikaranai. Known for its focus on women-centric stories and engaging performances, the troupe has been steadily building a repertoire that combines humour with observations on everyday life.

Gajasanakasi is a comic play revolving around six women and their take on life. Each character brings a distinct perspective and personality to the story. Their interactions lead to several hilarious situations and provide plenty of scope for humour.

The play promises to be an entertaining, light-hearted production that allows the audience to unwind and enjoy an evening of laughter.

'Gajasanakasi' is written by R. Kesavan who is well-known in Tamil theatre circles. The music is

scored by popular music composer Dakshin. The script is infused with unbridled humour, wit and sarcasm while drawing references from the current social and political scenario in the state and the country. These contemporary references make the play relatable to the audience and adds an element of topical humour to the narrative, said a release.

Journey of drama troupe

"I am an avid drama lover and have acted in several plays during my school and college days. Later as a journalist I have watched and reviewed plays staged by amateur and professional players. During the pandemic, when most of us were stuck at homes. I thought drama as a form of art will be a stress-buster not only for the players but also the audience. Since I live in a 203-flat gated community, I shared my thoughts of forming a drama group with my friends. Some of them jumped at the idea and Sarvam Nataka Priyas was born in November 2021," says B. Vijayalakshmi, founder of Sarvam Nataka Priyas and a senior journalist.



From a previous production; and (below) the team rehearse for their upcoming show



Sarvam Nataka Priyas comprises career women, homemakers and techies who stay in and around Pallikaranai and Velachery. The troupe has staged their plays in Chennai and other cities including at colleges, clubs, gated communities, cultural centres and old age homes. Rehearsing for the play is one big challenge these women face as all of them have different work timings and household chores. Sometimes they rehearse online and meet up after 9 p.m.

Beyond comedy, the drama troupe has experimented with thriller. *Konnathu Neethana?*, their ninth production, written by Kesa-

van was a thriller. The whodunit marked a departure from the troupe's earlier productions and gave the performers an opportunity to explore a more intense and suspense-driven narrative, added the release. The play's intriguing storyline, coupled with the performances and suspenseful moments, struck a chord with theatre-goers. From humour and satire to mystery and suspense, the all-women ensemble wants to explore varied themes while keeping its performances engaging and accessible to audiences.

For details, write to sarvamnatakapriyas@gmail.com

Other productions

Their debut short play 'No escape from Corona' was topical and an instant hit with the audience. The play 'Ninaithal Nadathalam' was about the bond women of different age groups share in a ladies hostel. 'Ethu Suthanthiram' staged during Republic Day dealt with challenges faced by parents in choosing a groom or bride for their children during these changing times. 'Natpukkaga Naalu Poi' dealt with friends in an apartment helping each other during emergencies. 'SMS', staged to mark Women's Day, revolved around the predicament of a career woman turned homemaker and her family who realises her value with the help of three goddesses Sakthi, Mahalakshmi and Saraswati in a humorous way. The plot of 'Idharkuthane Aasai Pattai Narada' was woven around Vaikuntam and Bhoologam and was about the nine characters being themselves without any iota of falsehood.

St Patrick's and Chettinad Vidyashram clinch Independence trophy



St. Patrick's AIHSS and Chettinad Vidyashram clinched the under-17 and under-14 titles respectively in the SMCA Independence Trophy inter-school tournament.

The scores (finals): Under-17: Gurunanak MHSS 143/8 in 30 overs lost to St Patrick's AIHSS 144/4 in 29.2 overs (R. Benitto Jose 51, Ananda Krishna 38).

Under 14: Ramachandra Public School 111/7 in 30 overs (Bhishma Ram 49) lost to Chettinad Vidyashram 112/4 in 20.4 overs (Aadharsh Rathnavel 41).

Payasam mela and Onam sadhya



Rain Drops, the hospitality venture from Kerala Tourism Development Hotels and Resorts at Greaves Road, is celebrating the Onam with a payasam mela and traditional Onam sadya till August 26.

The payasam mela features a delightful variety of traditional Kerala payasams. The highlights include pineapple payasam, chakka payasam, pazham payasam, palada payasam, parippu pradhaman, ada pradhaman, kadala parippu payasam, carrot payasam, paal payasam and gothambu payasam.

A traditional Onam sadya will be served on August 23rd and August 26th with 29 items. A special buffet Onam sadya will also be available, featuring an array of authentic Kerala delicacies.

Cost of payasam is ₹450 per litre and ₹280 for half litre; Onam sadya is ₹899 per person and buffet sadya is ₹599 per person.

The Onam celebrations were inaugurated on August 21 by Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty.

For bookings and enquiries, WhatsApp: 9498410098, 9188127752 | Phone: 044-28292150

ORCA is champion

ORCA emerged champions in the Junior Aquatics Championships held recently at Anna Swimming Pool under the theme 'Better Health, Better You.'

SDAT Chennai finished second while Sishya School, Adyar secured the third place. The event was organised by APJ Health Bot LLP, led by its director Ajay Vijendran, along with Dr. T. Pavani, Pedodontist, Adyar

The championship was graced by J. C. D. Prabhakar, speaker of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, and Omana Thomas, principal, Sishya School, Adyar. J. Meghanath Reddy, member secretary, Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT), and T. V. Vamsidhar, additional commissioner of Income Tax, Government of India, also graced the occasion. Around 150 young swimmers participated in nearly 100 events, making the championship a grand success.

The organisers emphasised that the championship was aimed at encouraging children to embrace sports, fitness, discipline and a healthy lifestyle while promoting the importance of participation and perseverance.



Chandragiri Fort and Madras

As part of Madras Week celebration, Storycorner at Bookmine is having a presentation on 'The Chandragiri Fort and its connection to the founding of Madras' on August 30; 9.30 a.m. at Hotel Palmgrove, Kodambakkam High Road. Sudha Umashanker, author, columnist and storyteller will be the speaker.

To register, Whatsapp 98402 47624

Baking workshop on August 28

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on mushroom cultivation on August 27. Another workshop on baking of cakes will be held on August 28.

According to a press release, there will be demonstrations on

making tea cake, banana walnut cake, ragi cake, gulab jamun cake, and coconut cake.

Both the sessions will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. Prior registration is required. For details, call 044 - 29530048



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Sadya at Sangeetha Veg

On August 26, Sangeetha Veg Restaurant is serving the traditional Onam sadya.

The sadya will feature crisp banana chips, 'sarkara upperi', 'pachadi', 'thoran', 'kootu curry', 'olan', 'kalan' and 'inji puli', along with pickles, 'pappadam', 'pazham', 'parippu' and 'nei', more 'kachiyathu' and other accompaniments. The feast culminates in the irresistible 'pradhanam'.

The Onam sadya at Sangeetha Veg is served at its three outlets - Adyar (9003003087), Virugambakam (7823958667), and Anna Nagar (8680001379) from 11 a.m. to 3 p.m. Dine-in bookings can be made at No. 9003003090. Customers can also book for takeaway and home delivery within a 3-kilometer radius. The Onam sadya can also be ordered online through Swiggy and Zomato, said a release.

MGM Healthcare performs robot-assisted knee replacement surgery



MGM Healthcare Malar, Adyar, has successfully performed a robot-assisted simultaneous bilateral total knee replacement on an 81-year-old patient with severe osteoarthritis, deformity, and multiple comorbidities.

The patient's persistent knee pain had worsened over the past few months, and she had become increasingly dependent on others. When it became difficult even to take a single step, she sought care at various hospitals. Given her age and comorbidities, she was started on medications.

Upon admission to MGM Healthcare Malar, Adyar, doctors diagnosed her with severe bilateral knee osteoarthritis. The patient also had severe comorbidities, including diabetes, coronary artery disease, a respiratory infection, and severe anemia.

A medical team led by Dr. Shriram Krishnamoorthy, senior consultant, Orthopedics, Joint Replacement and Robotic Surgery, successfully performed the high-risk surgery. A multidisciplinary team comprising experts from Orthopedics, Pulmonology, Cardiology, Internal Medicine and Anaesthesiology worked together to optimize the patient's condition before surgery.

The team performed the surgery with the assistance of a computer-guided robotic arm to ensure utmost precision and accuracy. The patient started walking without support within a couple of days. The patient also received comprehensive multidisciplinary post-operative care, including physiotherapy, anticoagulation, diabetic management, respiratory care, nutritional support, and additional blood transfusions to address post-operative anemia.

Obesity clinic launched in Adyar

RJ Aesthetics has launched an obesity clinic at Adyar, offering personalised, medically guided solutions for individuals with excess weight and obesity.

The clinic is led by Dr. Shanmuga Prakash, a consultant plastic, cosmetic, and hair transplant surgeon, and Dr. A.C. Vikram, a consultant surgical gastroenterologist and weight-loss specialist. The clinic provides a comprehensive approach to weight management, including lifestyle and nutritional interventions, medical weight-loss therapies, and, where appropriate, metabolic and bariatric surgery.

For individuals who achieve significant weight loss, excess or loose skin can remain, causing functional discomfort or affecting body image. Post-weight-loss body-contouring procedures can address these concerns after weight stabilisation, stated a release from the clinic.

The clinic is located at Number: 5, 16th Cross Street, Indira Nagar, Adyar. For appointments, call: 9840314263.



Coffee House opens third outlet in Chennai



Cafe Coffee House has opened its third outlet, located on Dr Thirumoorthy Nagar Main Road, near GG Hospital, Nungambakkam.

The evening launch was marked by music and special offers, bringing together family, friends, and influencers.

The menu at the outlet includes burgers, pizzas, sandwiches, wraps, pasta, fried chicken, seafood, grilled dishes, and snacks, as well as coffee and other beverages.

Kishore, the outlet founder, says the idea of opening a cafe outlet stemmed from an experience when he was studying in college.

"During my college days, menus at cafes were expensive and would cost around ₹350. My pocket money at the time was around ₹100-₹150. The outlet will offer a café-style experience at more approachable prices."

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